

JS

Keywords, Special Identifiers & React

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ES6+ React JSX Best Practices camelCase

TOPICS COVERED

■ JavaScript Reserved Keywords

These are **built-in language keywords**. You **cannot** use them as variable, function, or class names. The JavaScript engine uses them to interpret your code.

■ Important

Using reserved keywords as identifiers will throw a **SyntaxError** at parse time.

<code>break</code>	<code>case</code>	<code>catch</code>	<code>class</code>	<code>const</code>	<code>continue</code>
<code>debugger</code>	<code>default</code>	<code>delete</code>	<code>do</code>	<code>else</code>	<code>export</code>
<code>extends</code>	<code>finally</code>	<code>for</code>	<code>function</code>	<code>if</code>	<code>import</code>
<code>in</code>	<code>instanceof</code>	<code>let</code>	<code>new</code>	<code>return</code>	<code>super</code>
<code>switch</code>	<code>this</code>	<code>throw</code>	<code>try</code>	<code>typeof</code>	<code>var</code>
<code>void</code>	<code>while</code>	<code>with</code>	<code>yield</code>		

■ Future Reserved Words

These may be used in **future JavaScript versions**. They are not yet reserved in all contexts, but avoid using them as identifiers to future-proof your code.

<code>enum</code>	<code>await</code>	<code>implements</code>	<code>interface</code>
<code>package</code>	<code>private</code>	<code>protected</code>	<code>public</code>

■ Special Browser / Global Identifiers

These are **not** reserved keywords, but they are already used by the browser as global objects or properties. Re-declaring them can cause **warnings or unexpected behaviour**.

<code>name</code>	<code>status</code>	<code>event</code>	<code>length</code>
<code>top</code>	<code>self</code>	<code>parent</code>	<code>window</code>
<code>document</code>	<code>location</code>	<code>history</code>	

Example — Risky vs Better:

Risky

```
const name = "Ali";
```

// ■ May show warning in VS Code

Words

Better

```
const userName = "Ali"; // ■ Safe & descriptive
```

■■ React Reserved / Special

In React (JSX), some names have special meaning and must be used carefully. They are part of the React API or JSX transformation rules.

1. key — Very Important

Used in list rendering for **performance** and **reconciliation**. You cannot access `key` as a normal prop inside a component.

```
{items.map(item => (  
  <li key={item.id}>{item.name}</li>  
))}
```

2. className — instead of class

Because `class` is a reserved JS keyword, JSX uses `className` to apply CSS

```
classes. <div className="box"></div>
```

3. htmlFor — instead of for

The attribute `for` is a JS keyword, so JSX uses `htmlFor` on `<label>` elements.

```
<label htmlFor="email">Email</label>
```

4. React Hooks — Rules of Hooks Apply

Hooks must start with `use` and must only be called at the **top level** of a React component — never inside loops, conditions, or nested functions.

<code>useState</code>	<code>useEffect</code>	<code>useRef</code>	<code>useContext</code>
<code>useReducer</code>	<code>useCallback</code>	<code>useMemo</code>	

■ Quick Reference: Valid vs Invalid

<code>const class = "test";</code>	■ SyntaxError	<code>class</code> is a reserved keyword
<code>const function = 5;</code>	■ SyntaxError	<code>function</code> is a reserved keyword
<code>const name = "Ali";</code>	■■ Warning	<code>name</code> is a global browser property
<code>const userName = "Ali";</code>	■ Valid	Descriptive, no conflict
<code>const userStatus = "active";</code>	■ Valid	Avoids global status property

■ Best Practices

- ✓ Use meaningful, descriptive variable names that clearly convey their purpose.
- ✓ Avoid global names like name, event, status, length, and top.

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- ✓ Follow camelCase convention for all variables and function names.
- ✓ Use PascalCase for React component names (e.g. UserProfile).
- ✓ Prefix boolean variables with is, has, or can (e.g. isLoggedIn, hasError).
- ✓ Keep names concise yet self-documenting — avoid abbreviations.

camelCase Examples:

```
userName // user name string
totalPrice // calculated price value
isLoggedIn // boolean flag
handleSubmit // event handler function
fetchUserData // async API call function
```

These notes are prepared by **Sir Yasir Ali Lashari** for students of **TITANS SUKKUR**. For any queries, contact your instructor.

